

**"THE ONLY THING WE HAVE
TO FEAR IS FEAR ITSELF."**

Franklin D. Roosevelt (1882–1945),
American president

FIGHT OR FLIGHT?

Like animals, people react to a threat by either fighting it or fleeing it. The fight-or-flight reaction evolved in ancient times, when people would either engage in aggressive combat or run from a large predator. These reactions are basically the same today, though in modern society, the fight reaction is more likely to result in getting angry and arguing, while the flight reaction involves alienating yourself from others.



GENDER REACTIONS

Males and females usually deal with stressful situations and potential threats in different ways. While males are more likely to adopt the fight reaction and react with aggression, females tend to take the flight reaction and leave the situation or find other people to help them. If their offspring are under threat, protective females may turn to aggression.

ADRENALINE RUSH

The adrenal glands sit on top of the body's kidneys, and they secrete the hormone adrenaline. This is always present in the blood in tiny amounts, but when the body is threatened, large amounts of adrenaline are released. The instant adrenaline rush increases the body's heart rate, breathing, and blood flow in response to the threat. In an emergency situation, adrenaline is used by doctors to restart a heart that has stopped or to relieve life-threatening allergic reactions to insect stings.